

Fresh FASHION

The young and restless in Bollywood are choosing to dress up in clothes by young Indian designers, nudging international labels and the older lot to the side

| By Jhilmil Motihar |

It's happened at least twice. At two widely-photographed events, Priyanka Chopra has nudged Jean Paul Gaultier and Alberta Ferretti aside to instead slip into a luxurious gown by a young Indian designer. In November 2008, the actor was invited to the unveiling of the decadent Atlantis hotel in Dubai. She had at her disposal the best couture that money could buy. But she instead chose to wear a mustard-coloured one-shouldered gown by young designer Gaviin Miguel. The designer, whose short dresses have been quite a staple in Chopra's wardrobe, was thrilled. Barely three years in the business of fashion, Swapnil Shinde was grinning as widely when he spotted the lissome Chopra wearing his lime green ruffled gown at the Stardust Awards in February this year. Shinde has styled a few Sunsilk campaigns for Chopra and the actor asked him to design a dress for the awards. "Sales of my long gowns went up by 60 per cent after Priyanka wore them," says Shinde.

Manish Malhotra and Tarun Tahiliani can go on vacation.

The young and restless celebrities are choosing to zip up and drape togs by the equally young fashion frat. If Prachi Desai, walking the red carpet at the Filmfare Awards 2009, for the first time, chose to look glamorous in a black Raakesh Agarwal gown, the equally new Anushka Sharma strutted on the IIFA green carpet in a blue Mandira Wirk blouson dress. The designer had absolutely no idea that the young actor was going to wear her cre-

▼ Swapnil SHINDE 27

CELEB QUOTIENT

Priyanka Chopra, Mugdha Godse (above), Amrita Rao, Urvashi Sharma

DRESS CODE

Statement pieces that are wearable and affordable

◀ Mandira WIRK 34

CELEB QUOTIENT

Minnisha Lamba (right), Anushka Sharma, Malaika Arora Khan, Gul Panag

DRESS CODE

Feminine and chic drapes

